

Demand Generation in Enterprise SaaS

Introduction

Executive Summary

For most SaaS businesses, insufficient pipeline is the primary barrier to growth and scale. Fire drills to produce more opportunities — where marketing is pressured to "run more programs" or sales reps are exhorted to "get more meetings" — can produce short-term surges in lead generation. But the following year, when the sales target increases by 50%, the limitations of these sprints become clear: they can't scale as fast as the aspirations of the business.

Selling to the enterprise amplifies the limitations of short-term approaches to pipeline. Enterprise buying cycles are often long, involving multiple stakeholders and many competing priorities. Tactical approaches to demand generation, where the only goal is to find a customer who might buy *now*, are ill-suited to support customers through a longer journey.

Sustainable pipeline growth requires a holistic approach to demand generation — a scalable machine that can produce results over a long period of time. This paper provides a framework for building the machine:

- **Drive website engagement** by leveraging PR, AR, digital, and other brand programs to drive traffic, and quality content to keep customers engaged and convert interested buyers.
- **Build the prospect database** by harvesting engagement on our website, leveraging third party programs, and mining reliable data sources.
- **Execute effective campaigns** against our prospect database across multiple campaign types and touchpoints.
- **Prospect directly** with outreach to specific individuals, through individual efforts by BDRs or AEs, consistent with clear account plans and aligned with marketing efforts.
- **Build and leverage a referral network** of board members, advisors, employees, partners, and existing customers.

To achieve these goals, we also need to:

- **Feed the demand generation machine** with account and contact data, buyer intent data, persona-based messaging, and engaging and relevant content.
- **Integrate and measure demand generation efforts** with well-defined processes and rigorous metrics programs.

Scope of this Discussion

This paper will not explain how to manage an SDR team, how to run marketing campaigns, how to build a partner program, or what a good prospecting email looks like. The purpose of this paper is to define a framework for demand generation — how to understand how the pieces fit together to create a sustainable machine.

To define the boundaries of this discussion:

- We assume an *enterprise customer*, involving multiple stakeholders and extended buying cycles.
- We assume a *direct sales model*, in which an account executive has primary responsibility for the sale, and partners (if any) operate side-by-side with the salesperson.
- We assume *product-market fit*. This means that we have (1) a defined market, (2) a common problem that exists within that market, (3) an ability to solve that problem, and (4) evidence that customers in that market will buy our product to solve that problem.
- We limit this discussion to demand generation for *net new customers*. We do not consider up-sells, and we make no distinction between generating leads for large initial sales vs land-and-expand approaches.
- We assume that the *target market* is well-defined by an *Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)* (the attributes of a hypothetical perfect customer) and a *minimum qualified customer* (under normal circumstances, the minimum criteria a customer must meet to qualify an opportunity).
- We assume that the *buyer personas* are well-defined, with messaging tailored to those personas.

Understanding Outcomes

Our goal for demand generation is to create *specific interest in our solution* based on its potential to address a customer's *prioritized business problem*.

Let's define the outcomes of our demand generation process:

- **Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL).** An MQL is an individual lead/contact that requires human attention. This is because either (1) sufficient activity has resulted in a "lead score" that meets our threshold for outreach, or (2) the contact has specifically requested a demo or meeting.
- **Qualified Meeting.** A Qualified Meeting indicates that a salesperson has accepted a *qualified meeting* with a customer in our target market, with a contact who has apparent influence.
- **Qualified Opportunity.** The output of demand generation is a qualified opportunity. This means that a salesperson has verified that we have (1) a qualified customer, (2) a business problem that our product can solve, (3) reasonable importance, priority, or urgency to solve the problem, and (4) reasonable access to at least one senior stakeholder motivated to solve the problem.

Measures of Success

We'll propose metrics for each aspect of the demand generation process throughout this paper. We'll illustrate "North Star Metrics" that should guide the function, and other key indicators that contribute to success.

Our North Star metric for pipeline generation is **qualified opportunities generated**. We recommend you focus first on the *quantity* of opportunities (and the customer segments they apply to) rather than the *value* of those opportunities, for the simple reason that for most enterprise products, the size of an opportunity is a wild guess during early stages.

Other indicators we consider important are:

- **Weighted pipeline growth** is our primary indicator for pipeline health. Weighted pipeline growth is not just an indication of pipeline produced, but the quality of that pipeline and the progression through pipeline stages. It measures combined sales and marketing efforts and is highly predictive of sales results. We discuss measuring pipeline health at length in our paper *The Healthy Pipeline*.
- **Number of MQLs generated**
- **Number of Qualified Meetings generated** (and MQL->Qualified Meeting conversion)
- **Qualified Meeting->Qualified opportunity conversion**
- **Cost per qualified opportunity generated¹**

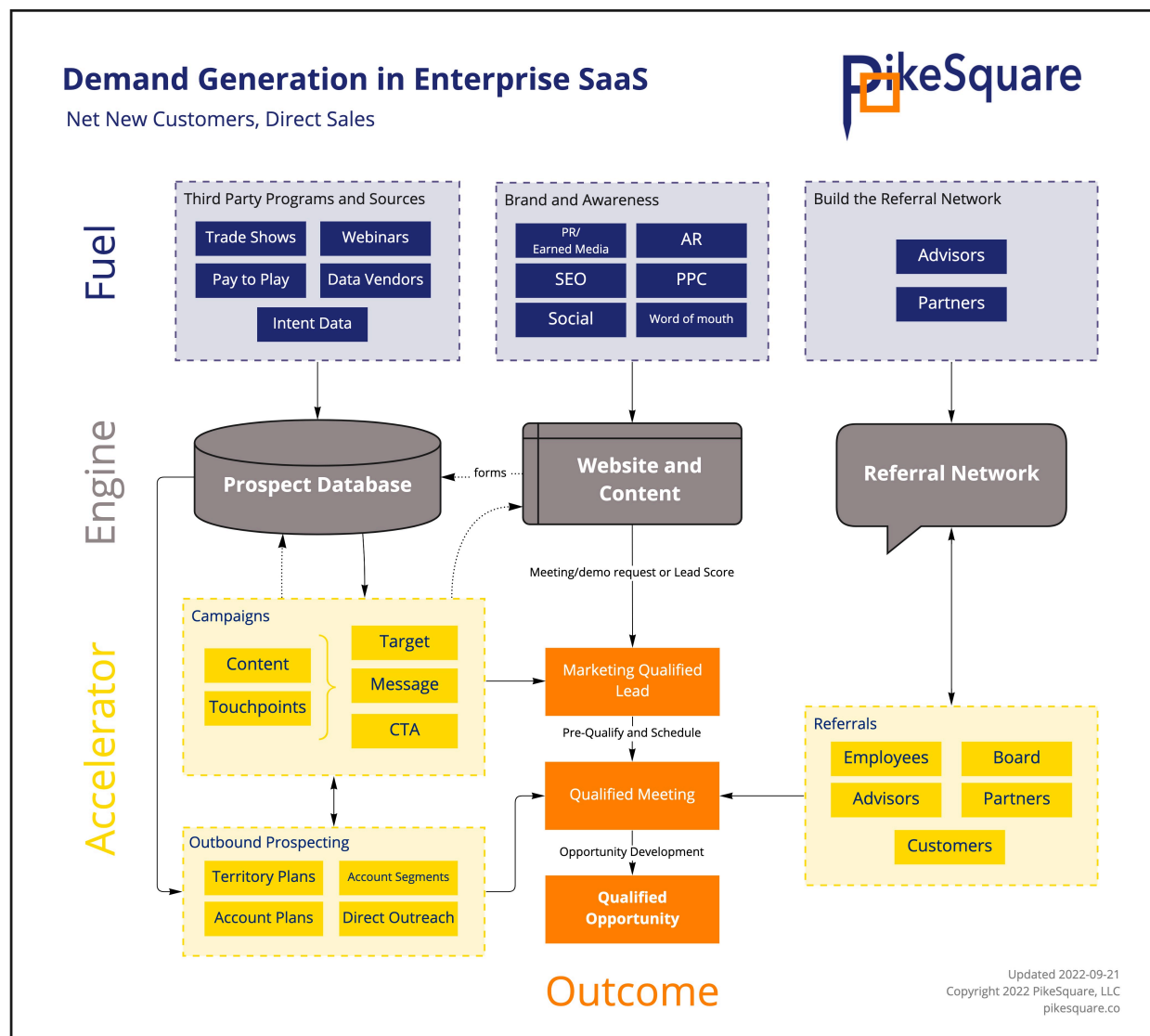
Each of these metrics should be evaluated as trend lines by time, region, customer segment, and other relevant groupings.

¹ Cost per qualified opportunity matters at scale, and when you are tuning and refining a demand gen model. When you are in the early stages of building your demand gen program, you may want to "get customers in the door at all costs" or "try a bunch of stuff and see if it works." Choose the right time to optimize for efficiency.

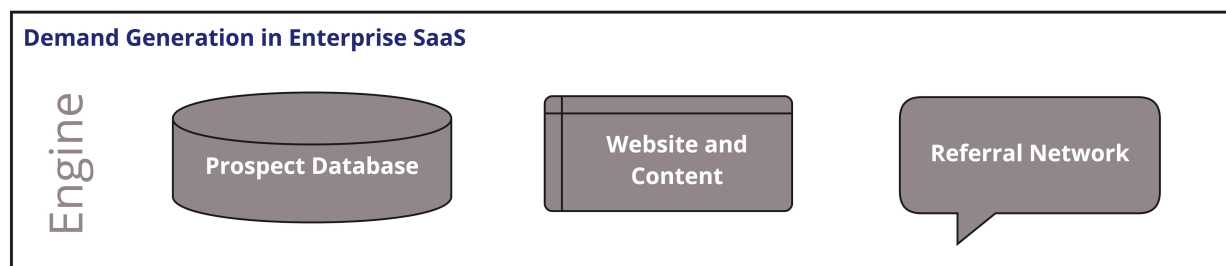
Getting Started

We're ready to explore the parts of our demand generation machine.

- **The engine** is the set of assets at the core of our demand generation strategy.
- **The fuel** represents the investment we make in building those assets.
- **The accelerator** will use the engine to develop new opportunities.
- **The outcome** of these activities, and the sole focus of our demand generation efforts, will be a Qualified Opportunity.



The Engine



We call the assets at the core of our demand generation strategy the “Engine.” There are three parts to our engine: the prospect database, our company’s website, and a referral network.

Prospect Database

Our prospect database contains the accounts in our target market, and the universe of verified contacts with potential interest in our solution.

The prospect database is the foundation for all field-facing demand generation activity. Demand generation campaigns are run against the prospect database, and all outbound prospecting starts with the prospect database.

Website and Content

According to CEB, nearly 60% of the buying decision is completed before a salesperson ever meets the buyer. This means that 60% of the buyer journey happens on the website. Our website must engage the buyer from general curiosity about the problem space to specific research about our solution. The website is also the center of our content strategy. To support demand generation, the website must:

- Speak directly to the target personas,
- Create long term engagement and credibility,
- Help the customer frame and prioritize the relevant business problems,
- Support the customer in learning about the solution,
- Capture information about the prospect journey,
- Harvest contact information (for example, by downloading gated content), allowing continued nurturing and outreach, and
- At the right time, convert the customer to a qualified opportunity.

There are two ways that a website can directly convert a customer to a Marketing Qualified Lead: (1) A visitor triggers a lead score threshold (for example, by engaging on the website enough to indicate authentic interest), or (2) A visitor specifically requests a meeting or demo.

Referral Network

The referral network is the universe of contacts who are not themselves (new) customer prospects, but who can *introduce* the sales team to potential new customers.

The best referral sources are:

- Board members
- Employees (including executives)
- Advisors
- Partners
- Customers

A well-constructed referral program includes processes for reaching out to the referral network and accepting a reference, rules of engagement for ongoing support from the referring party, and a model for how the reference benefits from introductions.²

² We plan to cover partner and other referral programs in a future paper.

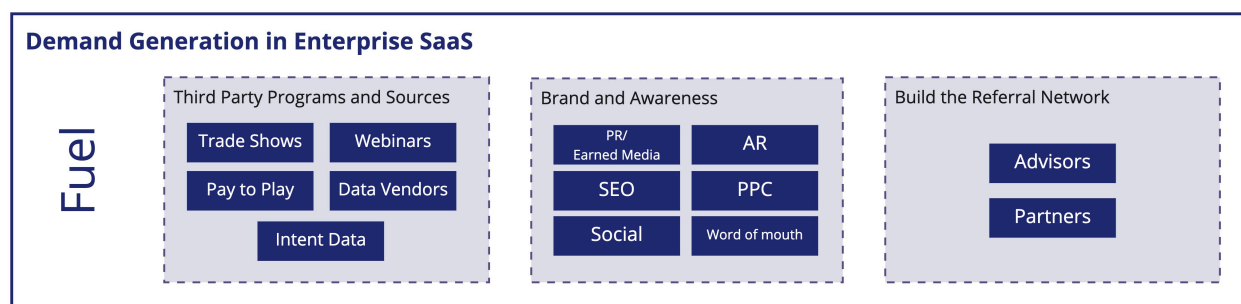


The Fuel

Now that we have defined the engine of our demand generation program, we need to provide the fuel. Each part of the engine needs a different kind of fuel.

- The prospect database needs accounts and contacts,
- The website needs visitors, and
- The referral network needs advisors and partners.

Let's take each of these in turn.



Third Party Programs and Sources: Grow the Prospect Database

Building the prospect database requires you to *find people you don't know* and get them to opt in to hearing more from you. In most cases, third party programs are the best source of growing the prospect database.³

Here are some techniques for growing the prospect database:

- **Trade shows.** Trade shows are valuable for many reasons. They are valuable branding events and useful for partnerships and recruiting. They can also be sources of new contacts for the prospect database.⁴
- **Webinars.** Third party webinars (including both industry-specific programs and general sites like BrightTalk and ON24) can be useful for finding new audiences.
- **Pay to play.** Some third party events are pay-to-play, and often consist of guaranteed "speed-dating" style meetings. These can help build the prospect database and lead directly to qualified meetings.
- **List purchase.** Purchasing or renting lists is a common way to build the prospect database.⁵
- **Data enrichment.** Companies such as ZoomInfo, Hoovers, DiscoverOrg, and others provide firmographic and contact information that can be loaded into (or integrate with) CRM. LinkedIn Sales Navigator is another valuable tool for identifying potential prospects.

³ A lot of the work to drive website traffic, explained below, also has the effect of adding to the prospect database. There are no hard lines between these efforts.

⁴ Trade shows should never be evaluated solely on a cost-per-qualified-meeting basis, where their performance is predictably awful.

⁵ Proceed with caution with list rental, as sending emails to rented lists may feel spammy to both your recipient and your email provider.

- **Intent data.** Data vendors including ZoomInfo and 6sense provide intent data that can indicate who is looking for certain kinds of solutions or trying to solve different kinds of problems. This can be valuable in directing and focusing campaigns and prospect activity.

Measurements

- North Star metric: Number of verified (and not opted-out) contacts
 - Segmented by in/not in target customer segments
 - Trend lines, with number of contacts added/removed

Build Brand and Awareness: Drive Website Traffic

In the context of demand generation, we focus on brand activities that drive potential customers to the website.⁶ Here are some of the ways to drive website traffic:

- **Third party programs.** The programs discussed above are valuable brand builders even when they don't result in additions to the prospect database. An engaging third-party webinar, a high-profile sponsorship, or a compelling trade show presence can contribute to brand and awareness.
- **PR and Earned Media.** A strong content and PR program, especially one that earns media attention, is likely to create interest that drives traffic. Applying for awards is another good way to get attention (and reasons to reach out to prospects).
- **Analyst Relations.** Analysts and other key opinion leaders exert strong influence on prospective buyers. It's critical to regularly brief key analysts and to secure positions in market reports (e.g., Gartner magic quadrant, Forrester wave, etc.) Sponsored research can capture analyst mindshare and develop valuable content at the same time.
- **Search Engine Optimization (SEO).** SEO is a critical element of the digital strategy. In developing an SEO strategy, it's important to consider search terms that are related to the business *problem* and not just your *solution*.⁷ SEO also depends on an effective content strategy.
- **Pay Per Click (PPC).** Selecting your channels for paid search and other forms of PPC is important for your marketing strategy. In enterprise, LinkedIn and Google are the giants.⁸
- **Social Media Marketing.** Depending on your buyer personas, social can have a meaningful impact on awareness and web traffic. At the very least, it's critical to participate in the conversation wherever buyers are gathered — whether that is LinkedIn, Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram. Paid social media (content that's promoted by spending money) can also form a part of your social media strategy.
- **Word of Mouth.** Self-explanatory.

⁶ Although in this paper we discuss brand and awareness only in the context of demand generation, brand has a far broader impact. Brand can help with funding and corporate development, recruiting, partnerships, customer loyalty, and sales efficiency.

⁷ Consider the following anachronistic thought experiment: You're marketing the first microwave ovens. You won't just consider keywords for "fast ovens" or "microwaves" but also for "weeknight meals" and "fast dinners" and "family dinners and working parents"

⁸ We've largely found Facebook and Instagram to be a waste of money in the enterprise. Similarly, we are skeptical about affiliate marketing, which creates a lot of junk traffic.

Metrics

- North Star metrics
 - Number of visitors: by channel, by repeat vs new, trend lines over time
 - Bounce rate (also by channel)
 - Outcomes
 - Calls to action (CTAs) such as form fills
 - MQLs generated
- Key indicators
 - Engagement: Downloads/pages per session, average session duration, visit frequency, attention minutes
 - Social: Shares, mentions, followers
 - Analyst: Briefings, mentions, features, reports
 - Media: Earned coverage/mentions
- Other useful information
 - Most popular posts/downloads by visit and attention
 - Most effective keywords and keyword rankings
 - Customers visiting (intent indicators)

Build the Referral Network

When it comes to building the referral network, we can assume that board members, employees, and customers are already connected to the company, and that there are reasonable routes to ask for referrals. Accordingly, we'll focus here on advisors and partners.

- **Advisor.** Advisor programs recruit senior people from industry (for example, current or retired executives) who devote their time in exchange for equity opportunities. Advisors can also take referral fees for closed deals based on qualified introductions. Advisor programs have become an essential part of demand generation strategy. A member of the senior staff (typically VP or C-level) should be responsible for the advisor program.
- **Partner.** Partner programs are critical but deserve focused discussion, and are thus beyond the scope of this document.⁹ Suffice it to say that partner programs can be among the most essential contributors to demand generation, and that recruiting and enabling the right partners should be a part of the demand generation strategy.

Metrics

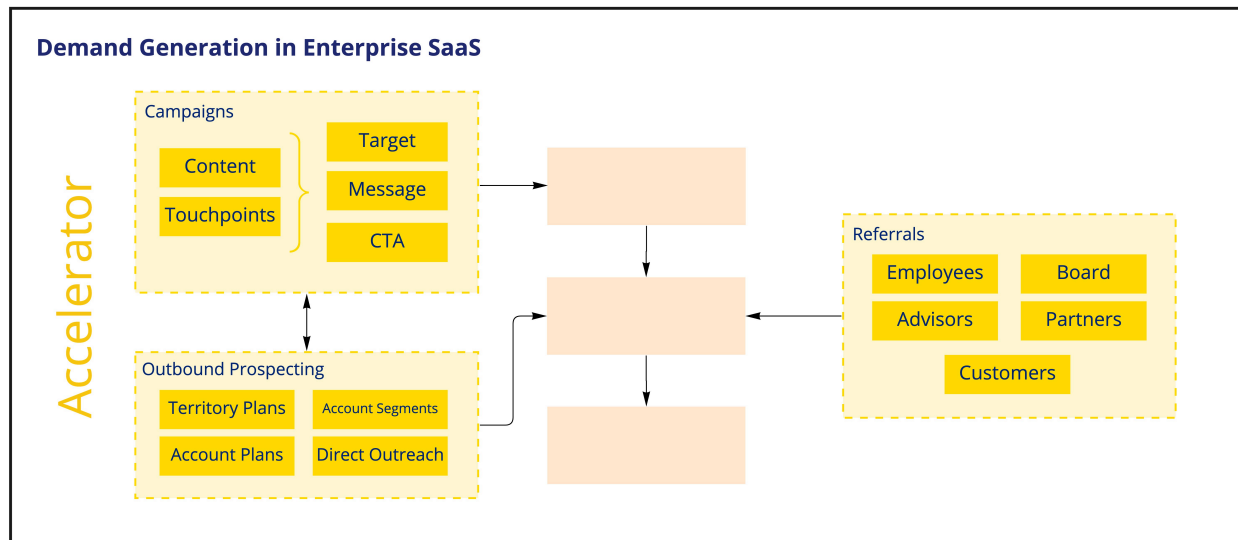
- North Star measures
 - Number/type of advisors and partners
 - Enabled/certified partner resources
 - Programmatic partner solutions developed

⁹ We plan to cover partner programs in a future paper.



The Accelerator

We have fueled our engine: our prospect database is richly populated with accounts and contacts, our website had compelling content and is getting valuable traffic, and we have a well-constructed referral network. Now we hit the accelerator by executing specific programs to create new opportunities.



Campaigns

Content

Content is essential to campaign success. Content takes many forms, including simple messaging, general interest stories, videos, white papers, blog posts, newsletters, analyst reports, original research, press releases, e-books, webinars, case studies — anything that your prospects will find interesting and engaging. Most campaigns will leverage content in its message and call-to-action.

Touchpoints

We reach out to our audience (the prospect database) through a variety of touchpoints:

- We send *emails*
- We make *calls*
- We send *physical mailers* (including fun swag)
- We post to *social media*
- We issue *targeted advertising*
- We hold *in-person events* (like executive breakfasts)
- We hold *digital events* (like first party webinars)
- We create *landing pages* with specific content or information

Campaign Execution

We coordinate these touchpoints through a series of campaigns. A campaign is defined by:

- **Who:** A target audience, represented by a set of contacts selected from the prospect database.
- **Why:** A message targeting that audience, sometimes with links to additional content.
- **What:** A call to action (CTA), which may be lightweight (“click to learn more” or “download this white paper here”) or a direct request for a meeting (“are you free at 10am on Thursday?”).
- **How:** The specific touchpoint(s) involved in executing the campaign, and the cadence with which they’re sent (as with a series of emails).

Special types of campaigns often get classified based on these characteristics. For example:

- **Account-based marketing (ABM)** is a strategy for marketing to individual accounts. An ABM campaign typically targets an audience of a single customer, with messaging and touchpoints tailored for that customer (for example, a customer-specific landing page).¹⁰
- **Nurture campaigns** are longer-running sequences of (usually) emails designed to motivate more engagement. Nurture campaigns can provide general updates (as with a newsletter), typically targeting a broader audience and with a lightweight CTA. They can also be designed to drive conversions, as with companies selling online trying to convert a free trial to a paying customer.

The purpose of any campaign is to get an existing contact to take an action — typically, to accept a (qualified) meeting. Campaigns are measured on their ability to drive those actions.

Metrics

- North Star measures
 - Qualified Meetings generated per campaign
- Key indicators
 - List (and number) of campaigns with targets, touchpoints
 - Events: registered, attending
 - Email: open rates, clickthrough rate, bounces, unsubscribes
 - Web/social: impressions, click through rate
 - Cost per Qualified Meeting
 - Campaign-level Qualified Meeting conversion to Qualified Opportunity

¹⁰ Please don’t get wrapped up in the circular reasoning that an ABM campaign is a campaign that you use an ABM tool to execute. If you find benefit in ABM tools, have at them, but you can certainly run customer-specific campaigns without specialized products to manage them. (One of my sales VPs once suggested that in enterprise, Account Based Marketing was what we used to call “marketing.” I think she was on to something.)

Outbound Prospecting

There is a fine line between outbound prospecting and marketing outreach. In many cases, we define the difference in ways that matter to us internally ("prospecting is done by sales and marketing is done by marketing") but are not terribly meaningful to customers.

In this case, when we refer to outbound prospecting, we mean something specific:

- Direct outreach to individuals,
- Conducted by sales reps or business development representatives (BDRs)¹¹,
- With the sole objective of scheduling a qualified meeting.

There are a couple of preconditions for effective outbound prospecting:

- **Territory plans and account segmentation.** Each sales rep (and BDR partner, if any) should have a clear plan for the territory, including segmenting all accounts (for example, A/B/C account designations) and identifying the goals and responsibilities for prospecting activities.
- **Account plans.** Outbound prospecting in key accounts should be informed by account plans that establish the targeted opportunities and stakeholders in those accounts. This should align with marketing activity in top accounts, especially when ABM programs exist.

Metrics

- North Star measures
 - Qualified Meetings generated
 - Qualified Opportunities generated
- Key indicators
 - Account plans completed/reviewed
 - Tailored emails sent
 - Live customer conversations
 - Cadence compliance
 - Qualified Meeting drop-out rates (meetings booked but not conducted)
 - Qualified Meeting->Qualified Opportunity conversion

¹¹ The line between marketing outreach and outbound prospecting is further complicated by the functions in Salesforce.com, which can make it desirable to tie this *sales* activity to a *marketing campaign*. Since this is not a paper on Salesforce best practices, we'll stay quiet and hope you don't think about out how weird this is.

Referrals

Referral networks are powerful because they bring immediate credibility to introductions and outreach. Board members and advisors can jump straight to the top of the org chart. Partners often have trusted advisor relationships with potential customers. Existing customers are powerful advocates.

- **Employee.** Ask all C-level and VP-level executives to go through their contacts and LinkedIn connections for possible connections to target companies. Be sure to recognize employees who provide valuable contacts.
- **Board.** Share target account lists with board members at every opportunity, and ask frequently for contacts and referrals.¹² Be sure to share the full pipeline with your board; there may be opportunities to leverage connections at a higher level than you've reached on your own.
- **Advisors.** Sit down with your advisors and understand where they have strong connections and contacts. Make sure they follow up on introductions to try and keep contacts warm and give you back-channel information. If your advisors are directly compensated on setting meetings or closed deals, be sure to implement and use a deal registration program, so there's never ambiguity on what constitutes a real referral or on what's expected from the advisor.
- **Partners.** Partnerships are so complex, varied, and important that they're beyond the scope of what we cover here. Suffice it to say that you should connect with partners at the corporate/strategic level and at the field/client level. As with advisors, be sure to implement and use a deal registration program, so there's no ambiguity on what constitutes a referral or what's expected from the partner.
- **Customer.** Ask every happy customer for a referral to a friend or colleague at another company!

A word of warning for referrals: customers who accept a meeting based on a referral often do so as a courtesy. The willingness to take a meeting tells you almost nothing about whether your solution addresses a prioritized business problem. Customers connected by referral are quick to take a meeting and slow to say "no." It can be tempting to overweight "senior-level access and interest" in evaluating referred opportunities. Continue to qualify the opportunity with the full stakeholder team at all levels of influence, and make sure you're tied to a business problem the customer already sees as important and urgent. For this reason, we suggest tracking referrals beyond the qualified meeting to confirm the qualified opportunity.

Metrics

- North Star measures
 - Qualified Meetings generated by source, over time
 - Qualified Opportunities generated by source, over time
- Key indicators
 - Advisor/partner opportunities registered
 - Qualified Meeting drop-out rates (meetings booked but not conducted)
 - Qualified Meeting->Qualified Opportunity conversion
 - Close rate of referred deals by source, over time

¹² Editor's note: One board member I worked with allowed me to sit down at his computer and look through his LinkedIn connections.

Outcomes: Creating the Qualified Opportunity

We have positive signal from our prospect, and it is time to drive towards a Qualified Opportunity — the start of our sales cycle.



Converting a Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL) to a Qualified Meeting

A Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL)¹³ is a person signaling sufficient interest in our solution through marketing channels. The goal is to obtain a Qualified Meeting with our prospect.

MQLs generally meet one of the following criteria:

- Someone requests a contact, meeting, or demo, and is a possible buyer in the target market,
- A person in the prospect database interacts with our website or marketing programs and triggers a “lead score” justifying personal outreach, or
- A target customer responds to a campaign's call to action.

MQL handling requires human attention.¹⁴ The workflow generally looks like this:

¹³ We distinguish between a Marketing Qualified Lead and a “Raw” Lead. A “Raw” lead — especially in Salesforce terms — is simply any interaction with any person. Raw leads are also long-lived (that is, a raw lead might live in the prospect database indefinitely without meeting a threshold for being an MQL).

¹⁴ In many organizations, this is handled by an employee who is trained in lead handling and/or outbound prospecting, often called a Business Development Rep (BDR), Sales Development Rep (SDR), or Lead Development Rep (LDR). For purposes of this paper, we will make no judgement as to whether this work is performed by a BDR or sales rep, and we will not take sides on the religious war of whether this function sits in marketing or sales.

- **Confirm that the MQL has been correctly qualified.** We're inspecting the MQL to verify that there's a reasonable basis for sales outreach (e.g., this is an authentic prospect in our target market). If it does not, we will reject the lead (and use our rejection reasons to tune our lead scoring).¹⁵
- **Initiate contact with the customer.** There's often a semi-automated cadence of follow-on emails or phone calls. If we are unsuccessful establishing the initial contact, we return the lead to the prospect database, where we hope that continued marketing campaigns will surface the prospect again.
- **Confirm our contact is authentically interested,** possibly navigating the organization to get to the right person.

Ultimately, the goal is to schedule a Qualified Meeting¹⁶, which means that:

- The customer meets the minimum qualification criteria to purchase,
- We have established contact with a person of minimum level/role/influence, and
- That person has agreed to meet with a salesperson.

(Note that the above steps generally do not apply to outbound prospecting or to referrals. Since we only prospect to people who would represent qualified meetings, we generally skip the MQL step and treat the result of prospecting activity as a Qualified Meeting.)

Metrics

- North Star metrics
 - Number of Qualified Meetings generated (over time)
- Key indicators
 - MQL Acceptance Rate (number of MQLs worked)
 - MQL->Qualified Meeting conversion rate
 - Time to convert MQL->Qualified Meeting
 - MQL time to contact (the amount of time that elapses between an MQL being generated and a reach-out)
 - Cadence compliance
 - Cost per Qualified Meeting generated

¹⁵ Some organizations use the term "Sales Accepted Lead (SAL)" to indicate that a BDR or AE has screened the MQL and that the lead is in a working status. Others use the term to indicate a Qualified Meeting. We avoid the term SAL here, since everyone seems to use it differently, and the term says more about the organization of the company (and possibly a compensation trigger for marketing or BDRs) than it does about the progress with the prospect.

¹⁶ Our best practice for using Salesforce.com is to convert the lead (or contact) to an opportunity once a qualified meeting is scheduled, so that the sales team can operate primarily in the opportunity record. It's also helpful to record information in the opportunity for use throughout the rest of the sales cycle. We use sales stage 0 (zero) to indicate that the qualified meeting has been scheduled and that the opportunity is under development.



Developing the Opportunity

We will now hold the Qualified Meeting. Our purpose is to *develop* an opportunity (or disqualify it, if we cannot). Opportunity development may require investment over a period of time, as the sales team navigates the organization, learns and shapes priorities, and confirms product fit for a prioritized business problem.

We advocate for a qualification methodology we call “PIPE”: for Problem, Importance, Players, and Effect.

- **Problem:** We can clearly articulate the customer’s business problem.
- **Importance:** We confirm that the customer views the problem as important, as evidenced by tangible factors such as budget allocation or the assignment of personnel to the problem.
- **Players:** We have access to business sponsorship that makes a commitment to meaningful next steps, and a preliminary understanding of the stakeholders.
- **Effect:** We can articulate the business impact we will make for the customer if our sales campaign is successful.

Once we meet these criteria, we have a fully Qualified Opportunity.¹⁷ The demand generation process has reached its end. It’s time to move the deal forward to close!¹⁸

Metrics

- North Star metrics
 - Number of Qualified Opportunities generated
 - Trend lines by time, region, segment
- Key indicators
 - Qualified Meeting->Qualified Opportunity conversion rate
 - Time to convert

¹⁷ Our best practice in Salesforce is to change the sales stage from 0 to 1, and to record the “date qualified” on the opportunity. We consider the conversation to a stage 1 as the beginning date for determining the length of our sales cycle. Once an opportunity reaches stage 1, our best practice is never to allow the stage to be reverted to a stage 0. (An opportunity may have one and only one qualification event.)

¹⁸ We benchmark the close rate for Qualified Opportunities at 20%. This benchmark is based on our experience at pre-“tornado” growth-stage startups. This benchmark is independent of time, i.e., a deal that takes another 18 months to close still gets included in our 20% benchmark.



About PikeSquare

PikeSquare is about building winning go-to-market teams. Our expertise is in enterprise software and SaaS.

The pike square was a military tactic that dominated European battlefields in the late Middle Ages. Teams of 100 men, carrying steel-tipped spears called pikes, moved in a ten-by-ten formation. The pike square was nearly invincible until advancements in firearms made pikemen obsolete in the 17th century.

The pike square required troops acting with exceptional coordination. A pikeman operating without the protection of the formation was an easy target. But well-trained and well-drilled troops acting together as a single unit formed a fast, agile, and lethal offensive weapon.

Enterprise sales, marketing, and customer success also requires that teams work together. PikeSquare draws its inspiration from this idea — that an integrated go-to-market team, acting in alignment on a single strategy — is a formidable business weapon.

Find us online at pikesquare.co, or contact us at info@pikesquare.co.

